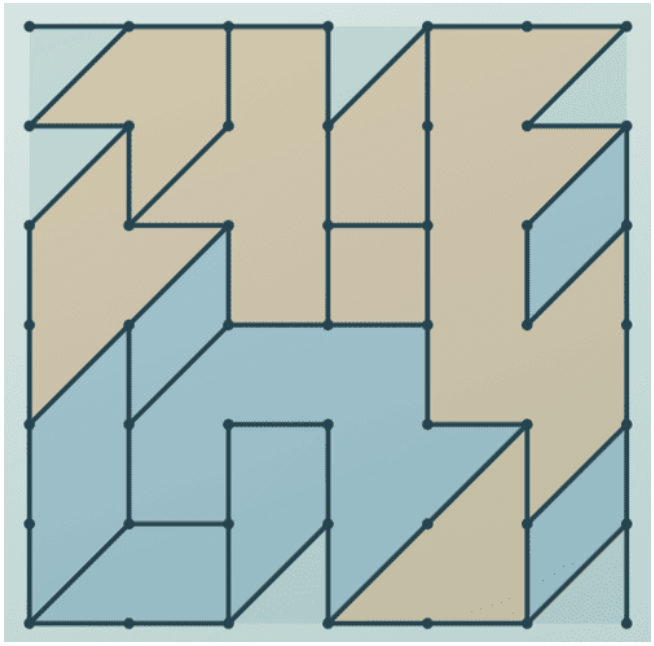
Trivalent

2026, Rey Alicea, https://boardgamegeek.com/thread/3764590



A square grid of dots. Every interior dot connects to up to 6 neighbors, not 4 — the usual 4 orthogonal directions, plus one fixed diagonal per adjacent cell. Each square cell has exactly one diagonal position available, not a choice of two.

Objective
Score more points than your opponent.

Turns
Draw one line per turn: any undrawn orthogonal edge, or a cell's diagonal (only while that cell is still whole and unclaimed).

- No dot may ever have more than 3 lines touching it.
- You can't draw a line where both cells it would separate are already claimed.

Claiming
If your line fully seals off a pocket of empty space, check its own boundary: it only becomes a claimed islet if that boundary touches at least 4 distinct dots. A single triangle's boundary only ever touches 3 dots, so a lone triangle can never be claimed alone. If a move would seal off a pocket below that threshold, it's simply not a legal move.

Claiming an islet grants another turn immediately. Keep going as long as each new line claims something.

Scoring
Each claimed islet is worth the number of distinct dots on its own boundary, minus 3 points. This rewards claiming a few larger islets over many small ones — splitting your territory into extra pieces costs you 3 points each time.

Game End
The game ends when no legal line remains. Higher total score wins. Expect a meaningful share of the board to stay unclaimed — that's normal, not an error.

Fair Play: Komi
The first player has a real, measured advantage on this board. To balance it, give the second player a fixed +7 point bonus added to their final score before comparing totals — the same idea as komi in Go.

Treat +7 as a starting point. If one side keeps winning comfortably even with the bonus, adjust it.